

jackett_cookie_login_hardening_challen

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-08-15T12:00:00Z **Status:** active
Maintainer: Track 11 " BOB-067 Lava-P4 port **Scope:** anti-bluff
regression guard for the Jackett cookie-login hardening

Overview

Autonomous CI-runnable proof that qBitTorrent-go/internal/jackett/client.go correctly handles the Jackett dashboard cookie-session login the MANAGEMENT API requires. Ported from Lava docs/autonomous-qa/PORTING-PLAYBOOK.md §8 (P4) " the source-of-truth Go reference is lava/lava-api-go/internal/jackett/client.go. Boba's implementation already carries the same discipline (cookie jar, CheckRedirect: ErrUseLastResponse, login(), doManaged() login-on-302-retry, wrong-password safety net); this challenge is the runtime-signature ratchet that keeps it that way.

Root cause (Lava P4)

Jackett's MANAGEMENT API (GET /api/v2.0/indexers, per-indexer /config) authenticates via a DASHBOARD SESSION COOKIE " not via the apikey. An apikey-only management request is answered with **HTTP 302** " /UI/Login. The apikey ONLY authorizes the Torznab /results + /caps feeds. A client that follows redirects lands on the HTML login page (200) and fails to decode it as JSON, masking the real cause; a client that does not follow gets a bare 302 and reports "unreachable" / "http_302". Either way the indexer catalog and per-indexer config path silently break " the exact bug the Lava porting document names.

Fix (Boba)

qBitTorrent-go/internal/jackett/client.go:

- cookiejar.New(nil) attached to the *http.Client.
- CheckRedirect returns http.ErrUseLastResponse (no auto-follow).
- login() POSTs password=<admin> to /UI/Dashboard; the Set-Cookie is captured into the jar. net/http stores response cookies BEFORE applying CheckRedirect, so this works whether the login answer is 200 or 302.
- Wrong-password safety net: 401/403 " explicit error; 200 with NO cookie " also error ("real Jackett re-renders the login page with 200 and no Set-Cookie on wrong password").
- doManaged() wraps every management call: first response 302 " run login() " retry once with the (now-cached) session cookie.
- NewClientWithPassword() injects the admin password at runtime (§6.R / §11.4.10 no-literal-credentials).

Prerequisites

- go toolchain reachable on PATH (challenge SKIPS with reason if absent).
- qBitTorrent-go/ module tree present.
- Live Jackett at <http://localhost:9117> is OPTIONAL – only the sibling `helixqa_jackett_fake_behavioral_equivalence_challenge.sh` uses it.

Usage

```
# GREEN – shipped regression guard (default is RED_MODE=0 in this script)
RED_MODE=0 bash challenges/scripts/jackett_cookie_login_hardening_challenge.sh
```

```
# RED – reproduces the pre-fix state (PASS if hardening ABSENT / broken)
RED_MODE=1 bash challenges/scripts/jackett_cookie_login_hardening_challenge.sh
```

What it proves

Runs three Go tests end-to-end via `go test -v -count=1` and asserts all three report `---` PASS: (not just the top-level “ok” line, which a too-narrow `-run` filter would also print with zero tests):

1. `TestFakeJackettRefusesManagementWithoutCookie` – the fake refuses apikey-only management with 302 `/UI/Login`. If this fails, every test built on the fake is worthless (11.4.107(10) golden-bad).
2. `TestManagementCookieLogin_DiscoveryViaCookiePath` – an apikey-only `GetCatalog()` transparently acquires the session cookie and returns the discovery JSON (drives `doManaged`’s 302 `login` retry path).
3. `TestManagementCookieLogin_ConfigurableAdminPassword` – a client built with the wrong admin password FAILs management instead of silently reporting success (verifies the no-cookie safety net).

Falsifiability rehearsal (paired 1.1 mutation)

Verified 2026-08-15 by patching `doManaged` to short-circuit past the 302 `login` retry:

```
// MUTATION B0B-067: replace `if !isRedirect(resp.StatusCode) { return ...`
// with a bare `return resp, nil` – the 302 flows out as a "decode: EOF"
```

Result: `TestManagementCookieLogin_ConfigurableAdminPassword` FAILED and the challenge exited with `rc=1` – the guard IS load-bearing. Reversed the mutation and re-ran to GREEN.

Honest boundary (Â§11.4.6)

- The fake is an `httptest.Server` written in Go; it proves the CLIENT speaks the cookie-login protocol. It does NOT prove the client works against every real Jackett version “ that is manual QA (Â§11.4.185) or a live docker-run challenge, tracked separately.
- `scripts/extract-jackett-key.py` reads `ServerConfig.json` from disk and makes NO HTTP calls; cookie-login hardening is not applicable to it “ it lives in the Go client that consumes the extracted key.
- Credentials in the fixtures are synthetic (`test-key`, `s3cr3t-dashboard-pw`) “ no real Jackett apikey or admin password is ever handled or logged (Â§11.4.10).

Cross-references

- Companion: `docs/scripts/helixqa-jackett-fake.md`.
- Source of truth (Lava): `lava/lava-api-go/internal/jackett/client.go`.
- Port doc: `docs/PORTING-FROM-LAVA.md` (P4).
- Constitution: Â§11.4.115 / Â§11.4.108 / Â§11.4.146 / Â§11.4.201 / Â§11.4.238.